‘DK? Is he a member of the political party DK?’

‘I don’t know. But he is an admirer of Prabhakaran. And he helps the LTTE with transport.’

Ragothaman quickly briefed Kaarthikeyan on the developments and information on Dhanasekaran and got back to Vicky. Kaarthikeyan immediately alerted the concerned people to find out everything they could on Dhanasekaran. Anyone entrusted with the responsibility of keeping Sivarasan safe must have been close to Prabhakaran.

Vicky resumed his story. The huge oil tanker that Dhanasekaran usually rented out to government-owned oil companies had picked up Sivarasan, Shubha and Nero from Kodungaiyur in Madras after midnight. The registration number of the vehicle was changed. Vicky remembered only the fake one—TAM 8998. Adequate care was taken to avoid any suspicion. The oil storage gauge had shown ‘full’. The air pressure in the tyres gave the tanker a heavy look. The three cylindrical interiors of the tanker were equipped with a mattress and pillows, a reading lamp, coffee, water, towels, snacks and analgesic medicines. Sivarasan had kept the AK-47 with him and given the 9-mm pistol to Shubha. Nero was without a weapon. He carried three duffel bags in his chamber. Dhanasekaran, Amman and Vicky had travelled in the front cabin while driver Selvaraj drove the tanker from Madras to Bangalore.[4]

Vicky could not tell Ragothaman whose idea it was to escape in a tanker. Vicky was to tap the wall between the driver’s cabin and the chambers twice if the tanker was stopped by the police. That would be the signal for Sivarasan and Shubha to take combat positions. And if the police insisted on checking inside the tanker, Vicky would tap four times and the fugitives would open fire. All this was due to the unavailability of a boat under increased surveillance by the Indian navy. Travelling in a boat was impossible, but the tanker was not stopped and checked at a single check post over the seven-hour-long journey. It was just one more oil tanker entering Bangalore. Sivarasan, Shubha and Nero were delivered to the house in Domalur, a developing Bangalore suburb near Indira Nagar. It was not an easy or comfortable journey for the fugitives. From there, Vicky took